

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump EPA proposes rule rollback

Agency aims for moves to eliminate landmark scientific rule that’s basis for climate regulations

By **Adriana Pérez**
Chicago Tribune

The Trump administration’s U.S. Environmental Protection Agency proposed on Tuesday revoking a science-based determination that pollution fueling climate change harms public health. The so-called endangerment finding has for 16 years underpinned federal regu-

lations for vehicles, power plants and other sources under the Clean Air Act.

EPA Administrator Lee Zeldin announced the proposed rule change on a podcast ahead of an official announcement in Indiana, according to Associated Press. The reversal was one of 31 environmental rules that Zeldin said in March the agency would roll back or

repeal “to usher in the Golden Age of American success.”

But critics say the Tuesday decision flies in the face of scientific evidence, especially as climate change accelerates and manifests itself — through extreme heat, toxic algae blooms, intense tornadoes and other threats to the Great Lakes — and beyond in California wildfires, Florida hurricanes and Texas floods.

“Here in the Midwest, we’re seeing the consequences of a warming world,” said Howard

Learner, CEO and executive director of Chicago-based Environmental Law and Policy Center. “The last thing we need is for the Trump administration to tie the EPA’s hands behind its back in this unlawful way that’s not grounded on prevailing legal standards, scientific reality or common sense.”

The proposal follows an executive order from President Donald Trump that directed the agency to submit a report “on the legality and continuing applicability” of

the endangerment finding.

The 2009 finding had established that carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, hydrofluorocarbons, perfluorocarbons and sulfur hexafluoride — heat-trapping gases released into the atmosphere by human activity — directly or indirectly threaten human welfare, specifically by driving climate change and extreme weather.

“It’s what it does in terms of the

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Group aims new effort at ‘rational’ redistricting

Initiative hopes to lift partisanship in state legislative boundaries

By **Rick Pearson**
Chicago Tribune

For the third time in little more than a decade, a bipartisan group is being formed to launch a voter initiative aimed at amending the Illinois Constitution to try to remove the heavy partisan influence of lawmakers in the once-per-decade redrawing of state legislative boundaries.

Unlike the current controversy in Texas, where Republicans are looking to redraw congressional boundaries to maximize GOP seats in the U.S. House for the 2026 midterm elections, the Illinois effort is aimed solely at Illinois House and state Senate boundaries.

And unlike two earlier efforts, in 2014 and 2016, that were struck down by the courts, the current proposal is more streamlined and designed to fit through the very narrow window that previous Illinois Supreme Court rulings have left for a constitutional amendment by citizens’ petition to appear on the ballot.

The formal unveiling of the effort is set for Aug. 19, when the Lincoln Forum and the Union League Club of Chicago will host a discussion with the movement’s leaders, former White House chief of staff William Daley and former congressman and U.S. Transportation Secretary Ray LaHood, the co-chairs of Fair Maps Illinois.

Daley is a longtime Democrat who is the brother and son of Chicago’s two longest-serving mayors, while LaHood was a Republican congressman from Peoria who served in President Barack Obama’s Cabinet. He’s the father of current GOP U.S. Rep. Darin LaHood. Co-counselors for the effort are veteran election attorney Michael Dorf, a former general counsel for the state Democratic Party, and former GOP state election board member and chairman William Cadigan.

The latest effort comes as the current process for redrawing Illinois House and Senate boundaries has received serious scrutiny and follows years of criticism after its adoption as part of the state’s 1970 Constitution. Its reliance on the legislature to formulate and adopt a map has been described as lawmakers choosing their voters rather than voters selecting their representatives in Springfield, resulting in sharp, partisan gerrymandered lines that have

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RYNE SANDBERG 1959-2025



Cubs fan Greg Howard visits Ryne Sandberg’s statue on Tuesday outside Wrigley Field to pay his respects after the Hall of Fame second baseman passed away at age 65. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Second to none

The Cubs Hall of Famer, who redefined his position with a rare blend of power, speed and defense, dies after recurrence of cancer

By **Meghan Montemurro**
Chicago Tribune

Ryne Sandberg’s eyes flitted to the empty practice field on a cool February day.

Sandberg, a regular presence at the Chicago Cubs complex in Mesa, Arizona, since his playing days in Cubbie blue, soaked in the sunshine and relished being back around the team during his cancer fight. It led to reflective moments, of the conversations he had shared around the batting cage with Cubs players to the moving ceremony eight months earlier when his likeness was enshrined in bronze along monument row outside Wrigley Field.

“I’ll never forget that day and what that all means,” Sandberg told the Tribune in February. “It’s incredible to see. And oftentimes I see a few fans around there posing for pictures. On occasion, I’ve walked up to them and said, ‘This is pretty cool, isn’t it?’”

Baseball fans flocked to Sandberg’s statue after the Hall of Fame second baseman — who redefined the position



Sandberg tips his cap to the crowd at Wrigley Field on Sept. 20, 1997, his final home game. **BONNIE TRAFLET/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

with a rare blend of power, speed and defense during his 15-year Cubs career — died Monday at 65, surrounded by family at his home in Illinois, the Cubs announced.

Sandberg battled metastatic prostate cancer and disclosed his diagnosis in January 2024. He shared news of his remission in August, but four months later he provided an update that the cancer had returned and spread to other organs, prompting more intensive treatment.

Through it all, Sandberg said he felt the outpouring of love from fans.

“The support has been tremendously overwhelming right from the first week, and it’s continued throughout,” he told the Tribune in June 2024. “It’s just been incredible and I think that’s been as much medicine to me as anything really.”

In his last public message to Cubs fans on social media July 16, Sandberg shared he had endured a challenging few months of treatment.

“While I am continuing to fight, I’m

Turn to Sandberg, Page 4

IN CHICAGO SPORTS: Ryne Sandberg left a legacy at Wrigley Field — and the Cubs and their fans were better for it. The Hall of Famer’s grace and dignity provided a perfect blueprint for every athlete to follow.

Migrant families displaced after fatal fire

Dozens caught off guard by Tuesday blaze in Austin

By **Nell Salzman**
and **Rebecca Johnson**
Chicago Tribune

When their bedroom filled with black smoke early Tuesday morning, Karen Jimenez immediately thought that she didn’t want to die thousands of miles away from her family in Venezuela.

“I grabbed my kids and just ran,” the 26-year-old said, still shaken several hours later.

Jimenez, who had just moved into the apartment a month and a half ago, was one of dozens of migrants who were caught off guard when the fire broke out in the Austin neighborhood early Tuesday. One man died.

Now, the migrants, who had been in the United States for less than two years, found themselves pushed into homelessness — a challenging reality under any circumstance, but especially

for people without legal status, financial resources or family support.

The blaze began shortly before 2:30 a.m. in the 18-unit building located in the 300 block of South Kilpatrick Avenue, said Larry Langford, a spokesman for the Chicago Fire Department. He said most of the building’s residents are migrants. A man believed to be in his early 50s was transported to Stroger Hospital, where he died of his

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INSIDE

Gaza’s Palestinian death toll tops 60K

The UK said Tuesday it will recognize a Palestinian state unless Israel agrees to ceasefire in Gaza. **Nation & World**

The flagship for pork in Chicago

A carnitas plate, with hospitality just as tender, at Las Carnitas Uruapan La Villita. **Food & Health**

TODAY’S WEATHER

High **80**
Low **66**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

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